A 9th Grade Navigator for Every School

> **James's collateral:** Built on James Arndt's "A 9th Grade Navigator (Dashboard) for Every School" (Oct 22, 2026). His headline, framing, and most of the first two sections are kept, in a more formal register. **Conversation:** Jonah (10/26): case-making goes up front, "we're having to sell ourselves more than some mega vendor," and it may be repeated inside the agreement's "what CHSS will do" section. Emily (10/26): lead with the case before the agreement. Jonah (10/27): make the language "a little bit more formal"; the audience is "overworked" and "a bit more stodgy." This revision removes contractions and colloquial phrasing and keeps the sentences short.

Connecting the CHSS Navigator to a district's Student Information System (SIS) gives the ninth grade team timely, accurate data through clear visualizations and a dashboard that updates automatically. The team can analyze, discuss, and intervene in minutes, without running reports, downloading files, or entering formulas. Few districts have a ninth grade dashboard of this kind, or the time and budget to build one. CHSS builds and maintains it for each partner school.

The cost of doing it by hand

> **James's collateral:** James's three-step routine and the 20-to-30-minute figure. His "no emails, no manual pulls, no file transfers" is reworded: SFTP is a file transfer, so the accurate claim is that nothing is manual once the automated feed runs. **Conversation:** James (10/23): "we waste 20 minutes in every coaching session running the Synergy report, exporting, opening, entering a bunch of Excel formulas." Only 20 of 178 partner schools had submitted first-quarter data as of 10/23. **James's collateral:** The Kid Talk figure is from James's 10/23 email: "Our own data shows us that when teams do a Kid Talk with fidelity they are 70%+ more likely to hit their on-track goal." Internal CHSS data; James and Tara to confirm the method and the permitted wording (Decisions, O16). **District lens:** A superintendent reading an earlier draft saw a credible value proposition and no evidence; one defensible result is what moves "acceptable" to "we want this."

Without an integration, nearly every coaching session begins the same way:

1. The ninth grade lead runs a report from the SIS.
2. The report is exported to a spreadsheet.
3. The lead and the coach add formulas to identify which students are failing one or two courses.

That routine consumes 20 to 30 minutes of a 60-minute session. Half of the hour goes to clerical work rather than to students, and the data is often a full grading period old by the time anyone acts on it.

District staff carry a burden as well. Each quarter, CHSS asks a district data specialist to prepare a large export and upload it to a secure location. That takes time from the district's most technical people, and the data is months old by the time it is used. Once the automated feed is running, none of that work is manual: no emails, no one running reports for CHSS, and no one handling files by hand.

This matters because the protocol depends on it. In CHSS partner data, running the Kid Talk protocol with fidelity is associated with a more than 70 percent higher likelihood of meeting the school's on-track goal, and a Kid Talk is only as good as the data in front of the team. [Method and comparison group to be footnoted once validated.]

What SIS integration gives the school team

> **James's collateral:** The first five benefits are James's. **Conversation:** The last two were added from the 10/19 and 10/23 calls: Tara and Jonah on longitudinal tracking (on-track through CTE, dual credit, graduation) and on end-of-year data arriving in October today, which makes it "really hard to evaluate our staff, evaluate our impact, plan for the next school year."

Student data flows securely from the district's SIS into CHSS Navigator, where CHSS builds the ninth grade dashboards the team uses. Teams stop assembling data and start using it.

- **Time returned to students.** The 20 to 30 minutes once spent preparing data goes back to the conversation about students.
- **Current data.** Weekly updates once the feed is live: Friday's data for Tuesday's meeting, rather than last quarter's.
- **Accurate data.** No manual exports or formulas means no transcription errors and no broken spreadsheets.
- **Faster action.** Teams identify students failing one or two courses and plan support in the same meeting.
- **Visible progress.** Teams can see whether each intervention is working and adjust before the next grading period.
- **A view beyond ninth grade.** As the cohort advances, Navigator continues to follow it: on-track persistence in tenth grade, CTE course sequences, dual credit, and graduation. The district sees whether the ninth grade work held, and so does its board.
- **End-of-year results in June rather than October.** Automated feeds mean on-track results are available when the next year is being planned, not after it has begun.

What it gives the district

> **Conversation:** The "support you to do something" reframe from the 10/19 call. Jonah: "instead of being seen as 'we're asking you to pretty please do something,' we're actually offering support." Luke: the first question to any district is whether its SIS data lands in a warehouse it owns every night; most districts that have reached that point "are doing the fun stuff." **Luke's experience:** Setting up SchooLinks and other nightly feeds at AFUHSD: once automated, "I don't think about it at all anymore"; a failure notice arrives if the receiving server is down. **AFUHSD precedent:** The executed-copy promise comes from the ASU-Helios thread (Mar 2026), where neither the assistant superintendent, the deputy superintendent, finance, nor the data team could find the district's own signed DSA a few years on. **James's MOU draft:** Section Seven: "Year 0 and Year 1 services are fully subsidized; the amount due from District under this Agreement is $0." The strongest fact in the package. **District lens:** A superintendent's concern about an earlier draft: committing staff to "a technically demanding project that the case-making describes as nearly effortless." The staff-effort paragraph and "support until acceptance" answer that directly. "You own your data" was read as boilerplate; it is now a path rather than a promise. "Costs nothing" was read as overbroad; it is now "$0 due to CHSS." **Conversation:** Jonah (10/26) on the start date: January "gives us the four or five months of let's get this set up before students start." Year 0 is readiness; live data begins with Year 1 in August 2027.

Most districts run reports by hand because no one has had time to establish the alternative. The integration work done together changes that:

- **$0 due to CHSS.** The accelerator, the dashboard, and the integration work are fully subsidized for Year 0 and Year 1. The amount due from the district under the agreement is $0. What the

work asks of district staff is stated plainly below.

- **CHSS sets it up with the district and stays until it works.** CHSS technical staff meet with the district's data team, map the SIS exports to the Navigator format, and establish the feed. CHSS remains engaged until the feed passes acceptance, and returns when the district's SIS, grading scale, or term structure changes. Most districts need two to four working sessions over a few weeks; the district's data contact runs the export, and CHSS handles the mapping and the monitoring.
- **A path to owning district data.** For a district that does not yet keep a nightly copy of its SIS data in a location it controls, the feed built together is a first step, and CHSS will share the routes other districts have taken. Once a district has that foundation, every future partner, dashboard, and analysis becomes easier.
- **Nothing to remember.** Once the feed runs, no district employee runs a report for CHSS again. If a transfer fails, CHSS's monitoring detects it and CHSS follows up.
- **Clean records.** The district receives an executed copy of every agreement, indexed, and a reminder before anything expires.

What CHSS asks of district staff. A technical contact and a privacy contact, named at acceptance. One onboarding call with both. The hours above to establish the feed, and more if the district needs the scheduled-upload route for a period. Nothing from teachers beyond the ninth grade team work the accelerator already requires. Data for the ninth grade cohort begins flowing in August 2027; the months before that are for putting the feed and the agreement in place.

Built to protect student privacy

> **James's collateral:** The opening sentence and "student data remains the district's property" are James's. **Drafting choice:** Discipline is removed from "only the data needed." James's draft and Emily's architecture both list it; Tara (10/19) said behavior data is rarely received and is not needed for on-track work; Luke (10/26) called discipline "the most tightly held thing." It remains available as an optional element in the agreement. **Drafting choice:** "Used for one purpose" carries a second sentence disclosing de-identified evaluation, so the longitudinal work is never a surprise. James's original ("and nothing else") silently excluded it. **Lewis County:** A Missouri partner district's technology coordinator has already asked its consortium to obtain the NDPA with CHSS, so the NDPA commitment is stated up front. **Conversation:** James (10/26): "we are going to have to sign their data agreement. There's no negotiation there." On 10/27 Jonah and Emily agreed to prepare to sign version 1 of the NDPA with Exhibit E, subject to counsel's review. Those are the records behind "will also sign the NDPA." **District lens:** "Do not label an incomplete list 'only the data needed.'" The list matches Exhibit D-1's Required elements exactly and names the screeners. **District lens:** A California district technology and privacy lead (10/27 call) reads every partner agreement for four things "with no gray area": auto-renewals, what happens when data is compromised, destruction at the end of the contract, and selling or advertising to third parties. Each of the four is a bullet on this page. **Luke's decision:** See Decisions, M9, M18, and M19.

SIS integration is governed by a data sharing agreement with the district and designed to meet FERPA and the state's student privacy requirements. CHSS provides its own privacy and security appendix and will also sign the National Data Privacy Agreement (NDPA) in the state's version if the district prefers it. Student data remains the district's property, and the district decides who may see it.

- **Only the data needed.** CHSS receives student ID, name, grade level and enrollment dates, course enrollments, course marks and credits by grading period, GPA, and attendance. Nothing else is required. Responses to the short belonging and skills screeners the school team administers, after the district approves the questions, are held under the same terms.
- **Used for one purpose.** Identifiable student information supports ninth grade success work in the district's schools and nothing else. CHSS retains only de-identified and aggregate results to evaluate and improve the program.
- **Deleted when the district says so.** When the partnership ends, or whenever the district asks, identifiable data is destroyed and the destruction is certified.
- **No automatic renewal.** The data partnership ends with the agreement. Continuing it requires a new signature, not silence.

Who sees what

James's collateral: Table structure and the school-team row are James's. His draft says CHSS coaches and staff see "aggregate data only"; that row changed because a coach who sees a student-level screen is seeing identifiable records, and his one-pager must change to match. **Conversation:** CHSS leadership decision, 10/27 call: coaching staff have standing access to the students at the schools they support, bound to screening and intervention purposes, with no platform-specific login language. Emily to send bullets refining the school-level binding. **FERPA:** "Disclosure" under 34 C.F.R. § 99.3 includes permitting access by any means. The school official exception authorizes it when its conditions are met. **District lens:** A California district technology and privacy lead (10/27 call): whether a partner's coach sees identifiable or de-identified data "is not a huge difference" once an agreement with destruction, breach notice, and subprocessor disclosure is in place. **Luke's experience:** AFUHSD's Teach For America agreement (2025–26) accepted the partner's coach seeing student-level data on the basis that the coach is the only partner viewer and is acknowledged as a FERPA school official. **Luke's decision:** See Decisions, M1, as revised 10/27.

Student names are visible in Navigator for one reason: so that the educators responsible for a student know who needs support and can act. Role-based permissions determine who may see them.

Who	What they see	Why
The school team (individual logins)	Student-level records: names, course performance, attendance	To identify students, build intervention plans, and monitor progress student by student
CHSS coaching staff assigned to the school	Student-level records for that school only, solely for screening, intervention planning, and the team's meetings; every access logged; the district may limit this at any time	To prepare for and support the team's work and to measure its progress
CHSS program and research staff	De-identified and aggregate data only	To evaluate and improve the program across the network
CHSS technical staff who operate the platform	Minimum-necessary, logged access to administer the system and investigate incidents; never for program or research use	To keep the platform running and secure

Records are matched using a consistent unique student identifier, so Navigator remains accurate as students change classes, schedules, and schools.